POWER BI

Every Power BI Skill a Data Analyst Needs at ₹12-18 LPA

The complete skill list for a mid-level Power BI analyst role, grouped into 6 areas, with what "good enough" looks like for each. Ends with a self-check.

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- **The 6 skill areas**
- **1. Data modelling**
- **2. DAX**
- **3. Power Query**
- **4. Report design**
- **5. Power BI Service**
- **6. Performance and business sense**

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The 6 skill areas

At ₹12-18 LPA, companies expect you to own a report end to end, not just build visuals someone else designed.

- **1. Data modelling**
  4 skills
- **2. DAX**
  5 skills
- **3. Power Query**
  4 skills
- **4. Report design**
  4 skills
- **5. Power BI Service**
  4 skills
- **6. Performance and business sense**
  4 skills

25 skills in total. Use the last page to score yourself.

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1. Data modelling

Most wrong numbers in Power BI come from the model, not the DAX.

- **Star schema**

  Fact table in the middle, dimensions around it. You can draw and explain it.

- **Relationships and cardinality**

  One-to-many by default. You know why many-to-many and both-direction filters are risky.

- **Date table**

  You create one with CALENDAR or Power Query, mark it as a date table, and link every date to it.

- **Clean column design**

  Remove unused columns, correct data types, hide keys from report view.

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2. DAX

You do not need 200 functions. You need to understand context.

- **CALCULATE and filter context**

  You can explain how CALCULATE changes filters, with ALL and REMOVEFILTERS.

  ```
  % of Total = DIVIDE([Sales], CALCULATE([Sales], ALL(Product)))
  ```

- **Time intelligence**

  YTD, last year, YoY %, rolling 3 months.

  ```
  Sales LY = CALCULATE([Sales], SAMEPERIODLASTYEAR('Date'[Date]))
  ```

- **Iterators**

  SUMX, AVERAGEX for row-by-row maths like Qty × Price.

- **Variables**

  VAR and RETURN to make long measures readable and faster.

- **Ranking and Top N**

  RANKX and TOPN for "top 10 customers" style visuals.

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3. Power Query

Clean the data before it reaches the model. Every step re-runs on refresh.

- **Shaping**

  Change types, split columns, remove duplicates, replace errors.

- **Unpivot**

  Turn month columns into Month and Value rows. Needed for any time analysis.

- **Merge and Append**

  Merge is a JOIN, Append is a UNION. You know which join kind to pick.

- **Parameters and folders**

  Combine 12 monthly Excel files from a folder automatically. Use parameters for file paths or dates.

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4. Report design

A manager should get the answer in 5 seconds.

- **Layout**

  KPI cards on top, trend in the middle, breakdown and detail below.

- **Drill-through and tooltips**

  Right-click a region to open its detail page. Hover to see extra numbers.

- **Bookmarks and buttons**

  Toggle between chart and table, or reset all filters with one click.

- **Consistent formatting**

  One colour for one meaning, ₹ in lakhs or crores, no 3D or pie charts with 10 slices.

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5. Power BI Service

Building the report is half the job. Sharing it safely is the other half.

Workspaces and apps

Publish to a workspace, share through an app, manage roles.

Scheduled refresh and gateway

Set daily refresh. Know when an on-premises gateway is needed.

Row Level Security

Create roles so each regional manager sees only their region.

```
[Region] = USERPRINCIPALNAME() mapping, or a
static role per region
```

Import vs DirectQuery

Import for speed, DirectQuery for very large or near real-time data.

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6. Performance and business sense

This is what moves you from ₹8 LPA to ₹15 LPA.

- **Performance Analyzer**

  Find the slow visual. Fix with fewer visuals per page and simpler measures.

- **Reduce model size**

  Remove high-cardinality columns like timestamps you do not need.

- **Define KPIs with the business**

  Write down exactly what "active customer" or "revenue" means before building.

- **Tell the story**

  Every page answers one question. Add a one-line insight at the top.

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Score yourself

Count how many of the 25 skills you can do without looking anything up.

- **20-25**

  Ready for ₹12-18 LPA roles. Put 2 strong dashboards on your portfolio and apply.

- **12-19**

  Close. Spend 3-4 weeks on DAX context and Power BI Service.

- **Below 12**

  Start with modelling and Power Query. They make everything else easier.

Interview tip: bring one dashboard you built and explain the model, 2 measures and one business decision it changed.

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